

Sofron Vasile-Stelian

Full-Stack Developer · Backend Focus (PHP / Laravel)

Bacău, Romania

Open to Iași relocation / remote

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SUMMARY

Full-stack developer, mostly backend. I work in PHP and Laravel with PostgreSQL and MySQL, and I have taken a product from design to production on my own: data model, business logic, REST API, security and deployment. I also handle the frontend when a feature needs it. I work spec-first and test-driven, and I am used to having my code reviewed, including on security. My background is in IT engineering, so databases, Linux and infrastructure are familiar territory, and moving from operations into building products is a good measure of how quickly I pick things up. I learn by building and pick up new frameworks and codebases quickly, and I would rather ask a question early than commit something I do not fully understand. Native Romanian, professional English.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

BACKEND	PHP 8.3, Laravel, Filament, REST API design, queue workers, schedulers, service and Action-class architecture, business logic separated from controllers
DATABASES	PostgreSQL, MySQL, schema and migration design, indexing and constraint design (unique / partial-unique indexes), transactional integrity, query performance
TESTING & PROCESS	Pest, test-driven development, unit and integration testing against real databases, code review including security review, spec-then-build workflow
WEB SECURITY	OTP / email verification, MFA (TOTP), CSRF protection, rate limiting, CORS, brute-force lockout, secure setup flows, OWASP-style fixes
DEVOPS	Docker (FrankenPHP), Coolify, VPS deployment (Hetzner), Cloudflare (R2, Pages, Workers), GitHub Actions CI/CD, Git, Linux administration
ALSO	TypeScript, React, Next.js, Astro, Node.js, Python; DNS and email infrastructure; monitoring and incident response

BACKEND PROJECTS

Apollo Booking: Appointment Platform (in production)

2026

Own product

PHP 8.3, Laravel, Filament, PostgreSQL, Pest, Docker/FrankenPHP

- **Designed and built end to end:** a Laravel backend with a Filament admin panel on PostgreSQL, with its own data model, migrations and seeders, managing appointments, calendar, specialists, services and gallery. Deployed and running in production.
- **Concurrency safety:** double-booking is made impossible through a partial unique index in PostgreSQL rather than an application-level check, which removes the race condition between two simultaneous bookings.
- **Public REST API:** public read-only JSON APIs (specialists, services, gallery) with rate limiting and CORS, used by a separate marketing site to pull services, specialists and gallery content.
- **Security:** request-to-confirmation booking flow with email-OTP verification and anti-spam protection; MFA (TOTP); a secured first-run setup wizard; rate limiting on public endpoints. Reviewed through repeated code-review rounds, including a security review.
- **Testing:** test-driven with Pest, 300+ tests run on every change, with business logic isolated in Action classes so it is reusable from both the admin and the API and testable without an HTTP request.
- **DevOps end to end:** Dockerised (FrankenPHP) and run on a VPS (Hetzner) through Coolify with a queue worker and scheduler; media on Cloudflare R2; marketing site on Cloudflare Pages consuming the APIs at build time, with automatic rebuilds triggered by deploy hooks fired from Laravel observers on content changes.
- **Architecture:** a two-stack design (a client-agnostic Laravel product plus a per-client marketing skin), with the stack, infrastructure and integration decisions documented alongside their trade-offs.

Security Awareness Training Platform (sigurantapenet.ro)

2026

Full-stack and security work on an inherited Laravel codebase

Laravel, MySQL, Blade, Tailwind

- **Legacy password migration:** migrated a legacy MD5 password store to bcrypt through transparent rehash-on-login, removing a critical authentication weakness across the whole user base with no forced resets and no downtime. Documented the trade-off: dormant accounts stay on the legacy hash until a planned cutoff.
- **Privilege escalation closed:** fixed a flaw where three unscoped password-change endpoints let any authenticated user reach handlers for other account tiers, including self-upgrading to a paid business plan.
- **API surface secured:** audited and secured 14+ unauthenticated API routes exposing user enumeration, campaign mutation and company data export, introducing role-based middleware as the enforcement layer rather than per-controller checks, so new routes are protected by default.
- **Vulnerabilities found and fixed:** a SQL injection in the video listing query, missing input validation on two rating endpoints, and password reset tokens generated with mt_rand() instead of a CSPRNG, all discovered during self-initiated code review of inherited code.
- **Responsible disclosure:** documented remaining IDOR and mass-assignment risks in a module owned by another engineer, with reproduction steps, in line with team ownership boundaries.
- **Frontend modernisation:** introduced Tailwind CSS v4 into a three-year-old Bootstrap/SCSS codebase using an explicit opt-in allow-list, enabling incremental migration of 37 pages with no regressions to untouched legacy modules, plus a design system of shared CSS primitives, reusable Blade components and purpose-built layouts.

OTHER PROJECTS

FINFORGE: Self-Hosted Household Budgeting App

2026

Own product · in daily production

React 19, TypeScript, Fastify, SQLite

- **Architecture:** React 19 and TypeScript on a Fastify and SQLite backend, shipped as a single container. Domain logic (surplus, recurring projection, goal allocation) sits in pure functions with no framework or storage access, and persistence sits behind a single storage interface, so moving from localStorage to a real backend touched the adapter and not the pages.
- **Concurrency and sync:** each save carries a global version and is applied in one transaction scoped to what the caller may write, so a stale version is rejected before any write and two devices editing at once cannot silently overwrite each other. Successful writes notify other logged-in sessions over SSE.
- **Security and process:** auth uses argon2id, opaque session tokens in httpOnly cookies, double-submit CSRF and per-route rate limits with the tightest bucket on login. Test-driven throughout, with architecture decisions recorded as ADRs, including the ones that deliberately keep features out.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

IT Systems & Security Engineer

June 2024 to Present

Class IT Outsourcing (Startech Team) · Fully remote

- Support 50 to 60 client organisations across Windows, Linux (RHEL/CentOS) and cloud under SLA-driven ticketing: incident triage and cross-system root-cause analysis, database and mail infrastructure, DNS, monitoring (Nagios, Wazuh), and PowerShell automation.
- **Internal tooling:** built a browser extension (JavaScript, Service Worker) that pulls monitoring data into the ticketing portal, removing the tab-switching needed to cross-check alerts during incident triage.
- **Production debugging:** trace faults across systems using logs and traces rather than guesswork. One example: intermittent mail delivery failures traced by correlating Microsoft 365 message-trace data against Linux relay logs to a timed-out IP, then to an outbound firewall block.
- **Automation:** write and maintain PowerShell tooling for recurring operational work, including scheduled jobs, notifications and reporting.
- **Linux scripting:** Bash tooling and cron-scheduled jobs on production servers, including incremental file backups (rsync, Borg) with retention policies and failure alerting.

Onsite IT Support Technician

September 2023 to February 2024

BSlash

- Onsite troubleshooting across the stack: applications (including web applications), Linux systems and servers, FortiGate firewalls, endpoint deployment and structured cabling. Working on applications directly, with access to the systems and logs behind them, is where I started tracing problems to their cause instead of escalating them, and it is what pushed me toward development.

Service Desk Technician (L0/L1)

September 2021 to October 2022

SCC Services Romania

- First-line support for end users over the phone, working to a ticketing process with defined escalation paths. First IT role: where I learned to diagnose a problem from a description alone, ask the right questions, and document what I did so the next person could pick it up.

EDUCATION & LANGUAGES

- **Education:** Bachelor's Degree in Information Technology Engineering, Vasile Alecsandri University of Bacău, 2019 to 2023.
- **Thesis project:** A ticketing and administration system for student accommodation, built in Laravel 9 with MySQL and Blade, covering authentication, a booking flow and data-table driven management screens.
- **Certifications:** JavaScript Development, Software Development Academy, 2023
- **Languages:** Romanian (native) · English (professional)